

LADY VICTORIA
designs

Venue Vetting Checklist

Before Booking + Multicultural Requirements

TEAM EDITION | TRACK: PLANNING | INTERNAL TEAM USE

TRACK: PLANNING

How to Use *This Checklist*

This is the **before-booking** vetting tool. Use it on every venue tour — before the couple signs — to decide whether the venue can support the celebration, the décor installation, and the production plan.

01 Record the **exact answer**, the venue contact, the evidence, the cost impact, the risk, and the follow-up for every question.

02 Ask only what matches the couple's actual traditions — and name each ceremony, procession, cooking method, fire element, attire change, language need, and family role.

03 Anything that affects the ceremony, décor, food, music, parking, guest count, budget, installation, or timeline must be confirmed **in writing** in the venue contract.

GOLDEN RULE

"Flexible" is not a written approval. If it is not in the contract, it is not confirmed.

CARRY IT FORWARD

Post-booking detail lives in the **Venue Evaluation & Walkthrough workbook (Final Walkthrough)**. Carry the answers recorded here into that workbook — do not re-ask them — so the team never answers the same freight questions twice.



FILL IN ON THE TOUR

Venue Review Record

VENUE

TOUR DATE

VENUE REPRESENTATIVE

WEDDING DATE

GUEST COUNT

PLANNER

WEDDING YEAR

OVERALL WEDDING BUDGET (RANGE)

CULTURAL OR RELIGIOUS REQUIREMENTS

01 Date, Hours & Curfew

- [ ] What time may vendors begin load-in, and when must setup be complete?
- [ ] What time must music, alcohol service, guest activity, and vendor load-out end?
- [ ] What overtime fees apply to event time, staff, security, cleanup, or late strike?
- [ ] Is there a local noise ordinance or amplified-sound limit that ends outdoor music earlier than the venue curfew?

NOTES · ANSWERS, CONTACTS, COSTS, FOLLOW-UPS

02 Real Capacity & Layout

- [ ] What is the realistic seated capacity with tables, stage, dance floor, entertainment, bars, food stations, lounge furniture, and cultural structures?
- [ ] Can the full guest count fit in the weather-backup space?
- [ ] If weather forces a change, by what time must the call be made, and are tents, sidewalls, heaters, or ground flooring permitted?
- [ ] Does capacity change for multiple ceremonies or room flips?

03 Alcohol, Bar & Certificates

- [ ] Does the venue hold the required liquor license, or is a temporary permit needed?
- [ ] Who obtains the permit, licensed bartenders, security, liquor-liability coverage, and certificate of insurance?
- [ ] Must the venue be named as an additional insured?
- [ ] What time must alcohol service end, and what bar fees apply?

04 Catering & Kitchen Rules

- [ ] Is catering exclusive, preferred-list only, or open to outside cultural caterers?
- [ ] May caterers cook on-site, and are tandoors, grills, fryers, woks, propane, refrigeration, water, ice, and waste disposal permitted?
- [ ] Can halal, kosher, Jain, vegetarian, vegan, allergy, fasting, and cross-contact requirements be supported?

NOTES · ANSWERS, CONTACTS, COSTS, FOLLOW-UPS

05 In-House Rentals

- [ ] Which tables, chairs, linens, tabletop items, bars, staging, dance floors, lounge pieces, and cocktail tables are included?
- [ ] What quantities, sizes, colors, and conditions are guaranteed?
- [ ] Are delivery, setup, breakdown, cleaning, reset, and damage fees included?
- [ ] May the dance floor be wrapped or covered with a custom vinyl wrap or overlay? What adhesive, installation, removal, and floor-protection rules apply, and who is liable for damage to the floor beneath?

NOTES · ANSWERS, CONTACTS, COSTS, FOLLOW-UPS

06 Décor Setup, Load-In & Breakdown Access

- [ ] Exactly how many hours are allowed for décor setup before guest arrival?
- [ ] Exactly how many hours are allowed for décor breakdown and load-out?
- [ ] Can installation begin the day before, and may décor remain overnight?
- [ ] Is the space on the same level as the loading entrance?
- [ ] Is there a loading dock, same-level entry, ramp, or service entrance for large pieces?
- [ ] What are the freight-elevator interior dimensions, door opening, weight limit, and reservation rules?
- [ ] Can oversized backdrops, stages, floral installations, carts, and rental furniture fit through every door, hallway, turn, and elevator?
- [ ] How far is the loading point from the event space, and are there stairs, narrow corridors, carpet, or guest areas on the route?
- [ ] Are dock times assigned, and can multiple vendors load in together?
- [ ] Where may décor trucks and production vehicles park after unloading?
- [ ] Are union labor, venue engineers, security, or venue staff required?
- [ ] What carts, dollies, lifts, ladders, scissor lifts, forklifts, or pallet jacks are allowed?
- [ ] When must the room be guest-ready, and who approves room release?
- [ ] What happens if access is delayed by the venue or a prior event?
- [ ] What dock, elevator, storage, cleanup, overtime, or late-strike fees apply?
- [ ] Where may boxes, tools, floral buckets, packaging, and production cases be stored?
- [ ] Who performs the final walkthrough, and how are damages recorded?
- [ ] Are real-flame candles permitted (including floating and votive candles), and what glass-enclosure or venue approval rules apply?
- [ ] What may be attached to walls, ceilings, and floors — and are tape, pins, hooks, confetti, loose petals, or sparklers restricted?

NOTES

07 Power, Rigging & Effects

- [ ] How much electrical power is available for lighting, entertainment, catering, and production, and where are the circuits and outlets located?
- [ ] Are dedicated circuits, a power drop, or a generator required or provided, and what do they cost?
- [ ] May chandeliers, florals, draping, or installations be hung from the ceiling? What rigging points, weight limits, and rigger requirements apply?
- [ ] Are cold-spark machines permitted for entrances and first-dance moments, and what fire-marshal, insurance, or venue approvals apply?
- [ ] Is a low-lying cloud effect (dry ice) permitted for the first dance? What rules apply to dry-ice delivery, storage, and handling, ventilation, and fire-alarm or smoke-detector sensitivity?
- [ ] Is atmospheric haze permitted for lighting and photography effects?
- [ ] If the venue loses power, is there backup power, and what happens to the event?

NOTES · ANSWERS, CONTACTS, COSTS, FOLLOW-UPS

08 Guest Parking, Valet & Arrival

- [ ] How many guest parking spaces are available?
- [ ] Is parking complimentary, validated, or paid by guests?
- [ ] Is valet required or optional, and what are the fee, minimum, staffing, hours, and gratuity rules?
- [ ] Where are the guest drop-off, accessible drop-off, shuttle, bus, limousine, and rideshare areas?
- [ ] Is overflow parking available, and is a shuttle required?
- [ ] Can vendor vehicles park separately from guests?
- [ ] Are there garage height limits, operating hours, traffic restrictions, or overnight-parking rules?
- [ ] Is the path from parking safe, accessible, and well lit in bad weather?
- [ ] Can a cultural procession occur without blocking valet, guest parking, traffic, or emergency access?

09 Total Cost & Contract

- [ ] Does the quote include rental, service charges, taxes, staffing, security, cleaning, rentals, parking, valet, power, elevators, docks, overtime, and damage deposits?
- [ ] Does the contract list setup and breakdown hours, loading access, parking, curfew, catering, alcohol, weather, and overtime terms?
- [ ] Will every important approval be placed in writing?
- [ ] What deposit and payment schedule does the venue require, and what are the cancellation and postponement terms?
- [ ] What insurance certificates must each vendor provide, and when are they due to the venue?

NOTES

SECTION 10

Multicultural *Wedding Requirements*

> *Ask only what matches the couple's actual traditions. Name each ceremony, procession, cooking method, fire element, attire change, language need, and family role.*

i Multiple Ceremonies & Spaces

- ☐ Can the venue host two or more ceremonies, room transformations, rehearsals, and cultural leaders?
- ☐ Is a prayer, preparation, or ceremonial holding room available?

ii Sacred Fire & Ritual Materials

- ☐ Are sacred fire, incense, oil lamps, candles, smoke, rice, petals, powders, water, oils, and ceremonial foods permitted?
- ☐ What fire-marshal approval, permits, ventilation, protective materials, insurance, cleanup, or staffing are required?

iii Processions & Grand Entrances

- ☐ Can the property support a baraat or other cultural procession, musicians, dancers, animals, or specialty transportation?
- ☐ What route, staging, timing, noise, rain, parking, valet, permit, insurance, and security requirements apply?

NOTES · THE COUPLE'S NAMED TRADITIONS

iv Attire, Language & Family Needs

- ☐ Are there enough private rooms for attire changes, stylists, family, elders, performers, prayer, nursing, and quiet breaks?
- ☐ Can programs, signs, screens, ceremonies, interpreters, and announcements use multiple languages?

v Extended Timeline & Guest Experience

- ☐ Is the rental window long enough for every ceremony, attire change, meal, performance, photo period, room flip, and rest break?
- ☐ Where will guests wait during transitions, and can refreshments be served?
- ☐ Can décor and ceremonial structures remain overnight with secure storage?

NOTES · ANSWERS, CONTACTS, COSTS, FOLLOW-UPS

11 Venue Red Flags

- [ ] Décor access is too short for the approved installation.
- [ ] The freight path or elevator cannot accommodate the structures.
- [ ] Guest parking or valet capacity is insufficient.
- [ ] Vendor parking, dock access, or elevator use is not guaranteed in writing.
- [ ] The weather backup cannot support the guest count and traditions.
- [ ] Hanging installations or chandeliers are not permitted, or no rigging points exist.
- [ ] Power is insufficient for the approved lighting, entertainment, and catering plan.
- [ ] Cold sparks, the cloud effect, or a dance floor wrap is not permitted when the approved design includes it.

12 Recommendation

OVERALL FIT ☐ Recommend ☐ Conditional ☐ Decline

DÉCOR ACCESS AND FREIGHT RISK

GUEST PARKING AND VALET PLAN

REQUIRED APPROVALS AND CONTRACT CHANGES

LEAD PLANNER RECOMMENDATION

CLIENT DECISION AND DATE